

8.2.3 Newsgroups

Alt.comp.freeware

Everyone loves freeware. Downloading, installing, executing and testing it without a moment's consideration. Which is why many malware/spyware dress up as freeware. There are many sites offering freeware downloads, but only a few allow users to post reviews about the application. Freewarefiles.com is one good example of such a site.

Alt.comp.freeware is a newsgroup that is dedicated to the discussion of freeware application. It is an ideal place for Neos to seek opinion about a particularly enticingly described freeware application. In the absence of user reviews for a particular application, this newsgroup is the best place to head to. This is a high activity newsgroup and answers are usually prompt and very relevant. Besides contributing to the newsgroup, the members also vote for the best freeware of the year, included in the Pricelessware.org site. So, one can be assured that the applications on the site are trustworthy.

Other Newsgroups

Some other high activity newsgroups related to IT are mentioned below. The subject of discussion can be inferred from the newsgroup name.

LANGUAGES: comp.lang.c, comp.lang.c++, comp.lang.java.programmer, comp.lang.javascript

HARDWARE: alt.comp.hardware.pc-homebuilt, alt.comp.hardware, 24hoursupport.helpdesk

LINUX: comp.os.linux.advocacy

COMPUTER GAMES: comp.sys.ibm.pc.games.action

There are many other newsgroups which address other tech areas and the entire list can be accessed at <http://groups.google.com/groups/dir>.

8.2.4 Conclusion

In conclusion, it is evident that most of the well stocked sites/forums are not based out of India. While a large database of answers will be of help to Neos, the Pros would be doing greater service by frequenting Web sites that are just starting off or do not have a large database yet.